



CONTACT

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in [linkedin.com/in/sabaza](https://www.linkedin.com/in/sabaza)
⊕ Available Worldwide
▣ Citizenship: Dutch

CORE CAPABILITIES

- › Public event & festival production
- › Technical, AV & staging production
- › Site logistics & crowd operations
- › Marketing, promotion & ticketing
- › Competition & tournament operations
- › Leading large multidisciplinary teams
- › Brand, sponsor & retail partnerships
- › Global supplier network & multi-market delivery

LANGUAGES

Arabic	Native
English	Native
French	Excellent
Spanish	Excellent
Dutch	Working
Polish	Working
Portuguese	Basic
Italian	Basic
Romanian	Basic

INTERESTS

- › Basketball coach; former national youth player.
- › Travelled across 100+ countries.
- › Active use of AI in event production and planning.

Sherif Abaza

Global Events Director & Producer · 20+ Years · Festivals, Competitions & Live Experiences

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◆ Profile

Global events director and producer with 20+ years delivering public events at scale — music and street festivals, concerts, sporting and esports competitions, retail activations and international summits — for audiences from a few hundred to tens of thousands. 800+ events across 80+ countries, built on a supplier, venue and partner network I can activate almost anywhere.

My work spans every component that makes a live event run: technical, AV and staging production; site logistics, crowd flow and safety; marketing, promotion and ticketing; sponsor and retail partnerships; and the leadership of large multidisciplinary teams — I built and ran a 140-person agency at peak. I am used to fixed timelines and hard deadlines: dropped into a live project, I map the critical path in the first week — scope, budget, risks, owners and run-of-show. Nine languages, including fluent French.

◆ Professional Experience

Sphere Events and Communication · Dubai, UAE

Founder & Managing Director 2008 – 2018

- Built from sole operator to a **140-person multinational events agency**; revenues exceeding **USD 8 million** annually across 800+ festivals, competitions, activations and conferences.
- Produced public festival franchises — **Street Nights**, **Marina Music Festival** and the **Dubai Chocolate Festival** — for audiences of tens of thousands: technical and AV production, staging, site build and logistics, crowd flow and safety, marketing, promotion and ticketing.
- Delivered the **KitKat 3x3 basketball tournament (Sharjah, 2013)** — court build and technical setup, team registration and refereeing, competition schedule, promotion and on-site brand activation.
- Organised **esports tournaments and in-mall gaming activations across Dubai (2014-2018)** — bracket and format design, LAN and broadcast setup, stage and free-play zones, sponsor integration and footfall-driven results for mall partners.
- Owned agency P&L and led large multidisciplinary teams — production, technical, logistics, front-of-house, stewards and client servicing — with clear briefings, run-of-show and comms structures.
- Long-term client relationships with **Siemens, Porsche, Cartier, Ericsson and Emaar**, plus mall, retail and brand partners across the region.

Abaza Business Services · Global

Founder & Managing Director 2019 – Present

- End-to-end delivery and on-site operations for **COP27 (Egypt)**, **COP28 (UAE)** and **COP29 (Azerbaijan)** — large-scale, multi-stakeholder events with mixed public and accredited audiences, multinational crews and immovable deadlines.
- Engaged as production and delivery partner by leading global experiential agencies — **Jack Morton**, **Shelton Fleming** and **Impact XM** — providing on-the-ground team leadership, production management and operational delivery.
- Project-based event delivery and advisory for clients across three continents, mobilising local supplier and venue networks at short notice.
- NBA market launch support: event programme strategy for European and African market-entry initiatives.

Withlocals B.V. · Eindhoven, Netherlands

Chief Community Officer 2022 – 2026

Chief Growth Officer 2018 – 2022

- Built and scaled a global experience organisation across **80+ countries**, **300+ cities**, engaging a network of 2,000+ hosts.
- Led the pivot to virtual and hybrid experiences, delivering **70+ corporate clients** in under 90 days on a proprietary platform.
- Partnered with Product and Engineering on the dashboards, automation and tooling behind performance and operational clarity.

ASDAA Burson-Marsteller · Dubai, UAE

Senior Account Manager 2004 – 2006

- Key role producing the **inaugural Dubai International Film Festival** — venue and talent logistics, accreditation and public programme delivery.
- Brand experience campaigns for Siemens, Adidas and Hilton across the Middle East.

FrontFlip (me360) · Kansas City, USA / MENA

CEO, Middle East & North Africa 2010 – 2015

- Co-led regional operations for a mobile loyalty startup; raised **USD 1.8M** and built a 35-person team across 6+ markets.

Sundance Events · Dubai, UAE

Business Development & Operations Manager 2006 – 2008

- Event business development and operational delivery for corporate and government clients across the UAE.

◆ Leadership & Development

AIESEC International

Various Leadership Roles 1999 – 2004

- Progressive leadership including Local Committee President and National Support Team roles — leading cross-cultural teams and international exchange programmes.

◆ Education

Bachelor of Computer Engineering

Arab Academy for Science, Technology and Maritime Transport · Alexandria, Egypt